

MSCI 102 Group Coursework Assignment

Subject

The first subject of the coursework is toilet roll supply chain – a commodity that has gone through an interesting case with the beginning of the Covid-19 Pandemic. The second subject is the portfolio approach to supply chain design for HP printers.

In particular, you are required to consider the key concepts covered in the lectures related to supply chain design, supply chain networks and the bullwhip effect.

Students are not expected to have any prior knowledge of the toilet roll sector for this coursework.

Requirement

You are required to submit a written report of no more than 3 000 words. In your report, you should do the following:

1. (2000 words) Read and watch provided materials about the toilet paper/roll shortages and their impacts. Explain how (if at all) the ideas/ situations in these materials on the subject of supply chain design, networks and dynamics. You may wish to do your own research to support your analysis. Specifically, you should –
 - a. Give a summary of the shortage events and describe the nature of the toilet roll supply chains. You can discuss the typical competitive priorities of a typical toilet roll brand.
 - b. Identify and discuss why shortages happened in the context of the supply chain and why the impact was prolonged. Elaborate on the discussion of whether the nature of the product or the supply chain design has an impact.
 - c. Read Lee et al's article on the bullwhip effect. Associate the demand shock and shortages with the bullwhip effect. Recommend solutions to mitigate the bullwhip effect for the toilet roll supply chain strained by the demand shock.
2. (1000 words) Read the article titled "A portfolio approach to supply chain design." Drawing on academic concepts related to supply chain design and the nature of demand discussed in lectures, you should –
 - a. Give a short explanation in your own words of what the portfolio approach in supply chain design means.
 - b. Describe how the supply chain of HP printer design has changed over the years and point out what factors influence these changes.

You should draw on lecture material whenever this is appropriate. You do not need to provide references to this material. You are free to consult any other non-academic sources, but you will only gain credit for this if it offers additional, relevant insight.

Resources

1. What toilet paper shortages tell us about supply chains
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qyiDDPvyN_I&ab_channel=FinancialTimes
2. Ted Talk: What Toilet Paper Can Teach Us About Supply Chains
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ihd7XJMzdG4&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

3. Forbes article 1: <https://www.forbes.com/sites/willyshih/2020/03/04/covid-19-shortage-gaming-and-the-toilet-paper-supply-chain/?sh=7b5955423457>
4. Forbes Article 2 : <https://www.forbes.com/sites/loracecere/2021/04/21/the-lessons-from-the-lonely-roll-of-toilet-paper-in-the-pandemic/?sh=2add8f3656f6>
5. Forbes Article 3 : <https://www.forbes.com/sites/forbesdigitalcovers/2018/07/12/why-the-rocks-social-media-muscle-made-him-hollywoods-highest-paid-actor/?sh=4bfe0e11136b>
6. Lee, Hau L., V. Padmanabhan, and Seungjin Whang. "The bullwhip effect in supply chains." (1997): 93-102. A copy is uploaded on Moodle
7. Olavson, Thomas, Hau Lee, and Gavin DeNyse. "A Portfolio Approach to." *Supply chain management review* (2010): 21. A copy is uploaded on Moodle

Assessment

1. This is a piece of group work worth 50% of the MSCI 102 course mark.
2. First part of the coursework is worth approximately double the marks of the second part, so you are advised to spend time and effort on these sections proportionately.
3. Equal marks will be given to the members of a group unless there are exceptional conditions. You should clearly say if you believe there have been exceptional conditions at the start of your report, and inform your course lecturer Alp Arslan.
4. The decision of the examiners is final and by submitting coursework you are deemed to have accepted their judgment.

Groups

1. You should undertake the work in groups of five.
2. You should try to organise yourselves into these groups and send Helena Greenwood (h.greenwood@lancaster.ac.uk) an email with your names and library card numbers.
3. If Helena does not think you are in a group by February 22nd we will assign you to a group and **we will assume that you consent to your email address being disclosed to the group.**
4. It is your joint responsibility to ensure that the group operates effectively. Please see the attached group work code of conduct.

Format

1. You should prepare the report in a style suitable for a graduate-level audience that has no specialist knowledge of topics in operations management.
2. You are strongly advised to organize your report according to the analytical tasks you have been asked to tackle. You are also strongly advised to follow the guidelines on report writing given in the Attachment.
3. The report should be integrated and coherent even if different parts are written primarily by different members of your group.

Submission

1. You should submit one electronic copy only, by **14:00 on Monday, 13th March 2022, week 19.**
2. Please put the number of your group, on the list that will be provided by Helena Greenwood, at the start of the report together with your library card numbers.
3. The electronic copy of your report in **Microsoft Word** format should be submitted via the MSCI 102 coursework section of Moodle. This will be checked for collusion and plagiarism. **Please submit only one copy, through one group member's account (it does not matter which one).**
4. Late work will be penalised according to the department code of practice. Any request for an extension beyond the deadline must be made by completing the required form. Please contact Helena if you need to seek an extension.